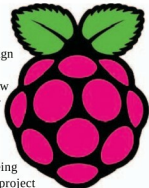


A Linux OS that runs on Raspberry Pi

Jacob Cook, a 23-year-old university student, has come up with ArkOS, a Linux-based operating system that can run on the Raspberry Pi hardware. Its creator's open source Genesis application offers a Web-based interface that can control the different services that run on your server. Genesis is open source with all of its files present on GitHub.

You can also download the ArkOS files and install them by yourself. The project, however, is still in its testing phase. Cook has begun a crowd funding campaign to raise money to enable him to focus on ArkOS on a full-time basis. He hopes to raise \$45,000 in the first few weeks with a collection of \$5,645 in pledges from over 100 backers. Cook has also set up a legal entity called the CitizenWeb Project, which will be the organisation responsible for the project.

The recent revelations with regard to the NSA being able to access so much online data provided Cook's project with an extra push. He feels that if the NSA can extract data from Google, Microsoft, Facebook, AOL, Twitter, and who knows what other services, who can you trust with your data?



Linus Torvalds announces the release of the Linux kernel 3.12



In a mailer recently, Linus Torvalds announced the release of Linux kernel 3.12. The latest release comprises support for offline de-duplication in Btrfs, performance improvements for AMD Radeon graphics, automatic GPU switching for laptops with dual GPUs, improved RAID-5 multicore performance, improvements in treatment of out-of-memory situations, developments in the timerless multi-tasking mode, improvements in the locking performance for virtualised guests, addition of separate mode setting and rendering device nodes in the graphics DRM layer, improvisation in XFS directory recursion scalability, addition of new drivers and many other improvements and bug fixes.

In the release announcement, Torvalds mentioned that the release does not include the merge window yet. And to those who are waiting, it is not even likely to be released with version 3.13, as he writes, "I'm not opening the merge window for 3.13 yet - since I won't have the bandwidth to really do merges anyway."

WordPress 3.7 comes with better security features



The version 3.7 of the open source content management and blogging platform, WordPress, has been released and it reportedly comes with better security and stability for users. According to the reports, WordPress accounts for the technology used for about 73 million websites all over the world. The new release has been named Count Basie by Matt Mullenweg, founder of WordPress. The name is in the honour of the legendary jazz musician.

While the WordPress 3.7 update is easy to use, the more anticipated development was the introduction of background updates. Earlier, users were

Firefox 25 arrives with better audio for gaming

Mozilla's Firefox version 25 was recently released. According to reports, the new version of the open source browser has the updated software, Web Audio. This reportedly extends the application programming interface across different platforms, including Mac, Windows, Linux and even Android operating systems.

The addition reportedly improves the audio support for browser-based games significantly. According to a Mozilla blog post, "We can attach the sounds of a roaring fire to my magician's fireball, hurl it away and hear the fireball moving towards its target. We can hear the siren of a police car approaching and hear how it passes by from the pitch shift known as the Doppler effect. And we know we can use these features without needing to manage the production of an audio engine."



Other features and tweaks have also been added to the new browser. For instance, Firefox now provides the option to migrate from another browser's history and settings if it hasn't been used for a long time. There are also security fixes that have been made to the browser. According to reports, five critical issues have been fixed, while there are also fixes for other less significant security issues.